

Our Ideal Client in Numbers

Sixteen key questions about the brands GrowMailers targets, answered in words and in figures · 28 September 2026 · Companion to the full DTC Market and Go-To-Market Report

How to read this: Each question has a short answer in plain English, then the figures. Figures cover the core client range of \$3M to \$20M a year unless stated. "(est.)" marks our own calculations from published figures. Section numbers point to the full report.

Q1. How big are they?

Our core clients make **\$3M to \$20M a year** from their own website, which is **\$250k to \$1.67M a month**, or roughly **3,600 to 23,800 orders a month**. Ascent also serves smaller brands (\$1M to \$3M) and larger ones (\$20M to \$50M+).

Client type	Yearly revenue	Monthly revenue	Orders per month (est.)
L1: Entry	\$3M–\$5M	\$250k–\$420k	3,600–6,000
L2: Core (sweet spot)	\$5M–\$12M	\$420k–\$1.0M	6,000–14,300
L3: Scale	\$12M–\$20M	\$1.0M–\$1.67M	14,300–23,800

Orders estimated at a \$70 average order. For example, a \$5M beauty brand does about 6,100 orders a month (Section 7.4).

Q2. What is their average order value (AOV)?

A typical order is worth **about \$70** in all four product types we target. Clothing brands, shown for comparison, average about \$103.

Product type	Average order value
Beauty	\$68.29
Supplements	\$71.26
Food and drink	\$69.87
Pet	\$69.95
Clothing (for comparison)	\$103.37

Triple Whale data, US direct-to-consumer brands, mid-2026 (Section 7.2).

Q3. How much does it cost them to win a new customer (CAC)?

Brands spend **about \$29 to \$45 on ads for every purchase**, and roughly **\$43 to \$67 for each brand-new customer**, because part of the ad spend goes on people who have bought before. Meta's ad prices rose 12% in a year, so this cost keeps climbing.

Product type	Ad cost per purchase	Cost per new customer (est.)
Beauty	\$33.44	About \$50
Supplements	\$44.81	About \$67
Food and drink	\$28.96	About \$43
Pet	\$32.68	About \$49
Clothing	\$39.24	About \$59

Ad cost per purchase from Triple Whale. Cost per new customer applies the 1.5 times rule from Section 2.4.

Q4. How much profit do they make on each order?

After paying for ads, the **first order barely breaks even or loses money**. Repeat orders earn about **\$17 to \$47 each**, because the brand no longer pays ads to win that customer.

Product type	Profit on first order	Profit on each repeat order
Beauty	\$5.49	\$38.93
Supplements	–\$3.48 (a loss)	\$41.33
Food and drink	–\$11.49 (a loss)	\$17.47
Pet	–\$10.29 (a loss)	\$22.39
Clothing	\$7.27	\$46.51

Section 7.2. Margins are planning estimates; replace them with each brand's real numbers.

Q5. What is a customer worth over time (LTV)?

Lifetime value (LTV) is what one customer is worth to the brand over time. Over two years a typical customer spends **about \$140 to \$230** and leaves **about \$20 to \$80 of profit**. Supplement customers are the most valuable because they reorder roughly every 30 days.

Product type	Orders per customer (12 / 24 months)	Revenue per customer (12 / 24 months, est.)	Profit per customer (12 / 24 months)
Beauty	1.6 / 2.1	\$109 / \$143	\$29 / \$48
Supplements	2.2 / 3.0	\$157 / \$214	\$46 / \$79
Food and drink	2.0 / 2.8	\$140 / \$196	\$6 / \$20
Pet	2.3 / 3.3	\$161 / \$231	\$19 / \$41
Clothing	1.4 / 1.7	\$145 / \$176	\$26 / \$40

Orders and profit from Section 7.3 (planning estimates). Revenue per customer = orders × average order value.

Q6. How often do customers buy again?

In the first year, the average customer places **1.4 to 2.3 orders**. Brands need a customer to buy **1.3 to 1.6 times** (beauty, supplements, clothing) or **2.2 to 2.5 times** (food, pet) just to earn back what it cost to win them, so repeat buying decides whether a brand makes money at all.

Measure	Figure
Orders per customer in the first year	1.4 (clothing) to 2.3 (pet)
Supplement reorder cycle	About every 30 days
Purchases needed to recover the cost of a new customer	1.3–1.6 (beauty, supplements, clothing); 2.2–2.5 (food, pet)
Value of lifting the 12-month repeat rate from 25% to 30%	About \$136,000 extra profit a year for an \$8M beauty brand

Sections 2.4, 2.5 and 7.3. Always check a brand's real repeat rate in its own Shopify data.

Q7. How many people work there?

Most core clients are **small companies of 8 to 40 people** with a **marketing team of 4 to 12**. Few have a dedicated email expert, and that gap is what Lhotse fills.

Yearly revenue	Whole company	Marketing team	Who runs email
\$1M–\$3M	3–10 people	2–3	Founder or a freelancer
\$3M–\$8M	8–40 people (across \$3M–\$20M)	4–6	First email hire
\$8M–\$20M	8–40 people (across \$3M–\$20M)	7–12	Retention specialist
\$20M–\$50M	40–80+ people	15–25	Head of Retention and a team

Sections 4.2 and 6.1. Example: a \$7M supplement brand with 18 staff and a three-person marketing team (Section 4.6).

Q8. Who makes the buying decision?

Below \$5M the **founder** decides. Between \$5M and \$20M a **marketing leader** signs, and above \$20M **finance** also reviews the contract.

Yearly revenue	Who signs	Who else has a say
Under \$5M	Founder	Usually no one else
\$5M–\$20M	Head of Marketing or Head of Growth (a VP or CMO at the top end)	The retention specialist
Above \$20M	CMO or VP of Marketing	Finance reviews the contract

Sections 4.3 and 6.2.

Q9. How much do they spend on marketing and outside help?

Smaller brands spend a **large share of revenue on marketing (30% to 45% under \$5M)**, mostly on ads. Spending on outside agencies is **about 5% to 7% of revenue**. Hiring one email manager costs far more than Lhotse.

Item	Figure
Marketing spend, brands under \$5M	30%–45% of revenue
Marketing spend, ten public consumer brands (median)	13.3% of revenue
Spend on outside agencies	About 5%–7% of revenue
One US email marketing manager, fully loaded	\$85k–\$135k a year
Lhotse, for comparison	\$36k–\$66k a year

Sections 6.1 and 6.3.

Q10. How big is their email list, and how much do they send?

A core client has **40,000 to 250,000 active subscribers** and sends **250,000 to 1.5 million emails a month**. In an unmanaged list, **about half the subscribers are inactive**, yet the brand still pays Klaviyo for every one of them.

Yearly revenue	Active subscribers	Emails sent per month	Klaviyo bill per month
\$1M–\$3M	10k–40k	50k–250k	About \$150–\$600
\$3M–\$20M	40k–250k	250k–1.5M	About \$600–\$2,300
\$20M–\$50M+	250k–1M+	1.5M–8M+	\$2,300+

Sections 4.2 and 11.1. A typical unmanaged list is 20% engaged, 25% warm or cool, 50% inactive and 5% fake sign-ups. Klaviyo bills are our estimate from its price list; check current prices before quoting.

Q11. How much of their revenue comes from email?

A healthy brand earns **20% to 30% of its website revenue from email and SMS**. Under 8% means there is no real email program, and 8% to 20% means it is underdeveloped.

Client type	Email revenue a year (at 20%–30%)	Lhotse fee as a share of it
L1 (\$3M–\$5M)	\$600k–\$1.5M	2.4%–7%
L2 (\$5M–\$12M)	\$1.0M–\$3.6M	1.2%–5.4%
L3 (\$12M–\$20M)	\$2.4M–\$6.0M	0.9%–2.8%

Sections 4.3 and 9.1. Above 40% usually means the brand's reporting gives email too much credit.

Q12. What must Lhotse deliver to pay for itself?

Lhotse pays for itself once it creates enough **extra repeat orders each month** to cover its fee. For a \$5M beauty brand that is only **1.3% to 2.3% of its monthly orders**. Food and pet need more orders because each one earns less.

Product type	Extra repeat orders a month to cover \$3,000	To cover \$5,500	To cover Ascent (\$5,000 once)
Beauty	78	142	129 in total
Supplements	73	134	121 in total
Food and drink	172	315	287 in total
Pet	134	246	224 in total

Section 7.4.

Q13. What tools do they use?

Every client runs **Shopify (or Shopify Plus) and Klaviyo**. Bigger brands add paid tools for SMS, subscriptions, analytics and customer service, and each of these signals a larger budget.

Job	Common tools	Share of US Shopify stores using it
Online store	Shopify Plus (about \$2,300–\$2,500 a month)	2.5%
Email	Klaviyo (required)	14.5%
Text messages (SMS)	Postscript; Attentive for large brands	1.7%; 0.58%
Subscriptions	ReCharge	2.1%
Ad tracking	Triple Whale; Northbeam	1.3%; 0.11%
Customer service	Gorgias	1.0%

Store Leads, 1,179,951 live US Shopify stores, September 2026 (Section 3.2).

Q14. What do they sell, and where are they?

They sell products people **buy again and again: beauty, supplements, food and drink, and pet supplies**. About **4,500 qualified brands** exist in our six markets, two-thirds of them in the US. Winning well under 1% of them is enough for GrowMailers.

Country	Qualified brands (approx.)	Note
United States	2,955	Main market, all year
United Kingdom	643	Best in January to March
Canada	389	Strictest email laws
Australia	380	Best in January to March and July to August
New Zealand	60	Add-on to Australia
Ireland	51	Add-on to the UK

Sections 5.2 and 5.3.

Q15. What problems are they facing?

Their profit is being squeezed from several sides at once, and email is usually the cheapest fix. These are the problems that make them call us.

Problem	In figures
Ads cost more every year	Meta ad prices up 12% in a year
First orders make little or no money	–\$11.49 to +\$7.27 profit on a first order
Paying for people who never open	About half of an unmanaged list is inactive
Stricter inbox rules	Gmail, Yahoo and Microsoft reject bulk email without SPF, DKIM and DMARC
Hidden spam problems outside the US	Microsoft holds about a third of inboxes in the UK, Canada and Australia
Thin email programs	Email below 20% of website revenue

Sections 2, 7, 11, 12 and 13.

Q16. When do they have money to spend?

Brands pay for holiday stock in summer, so **cash is tightest in August and September** and **most available in January and February**. Budgets reset at different times in each country.

Market	New budget year starts	Best time to pitch Lhotse
United States	January	Best in January to February; good from March to August
Canada	January	Steady from January to August (contacts must meet Canada's email law)
UK and Ireland	January, some brands in April	Best in January to February; good from June to August
Australia and New Zealand	July (Australia); often April (NZ)	Best in June to August; good in January to February

Sections 8.1, 8.3 and 15.4. From mid-October to December every market is in its Black Friday freeze.